



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lewis Clark Christian School
School Website: <https://lewisclarkchristianschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Lewis Clark Christian School (Lewiston, ID) presents a robust Christian, classical-leaning program that emphasizes formation, virtue, and a biblically grounded worldview. Public materials consistently tie education to discipleship, community, and a biblical framework for life, with explicit theology-forming components such as a Statement of Faith, integration of Bible and theology into humanities, and a mission centered on godly character and family partnership. The curriculum shows clear classical markers—Latin study, rhetoric, a history-focused humanities approach, and a two-hour humanities block intended to weave worldview across disciplines. There are strong signs of communal practices (fellowship, family involvement, mentoring across grades) and a living-teacher/mentorship ethos, including explicit mention of older students mentoring younger ones.

Overall, the school aligns with many core classical elements, particularly in religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-focused aims, and a curriculum enriched with the humanities, rhetoric, and Latin. Some aspects that typically accompany a fully classical model—open advocacy for Great Books, explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, and a fully articulated “living curriculum” faculty culture—are less evident in public-facing content. Taken together, the school is best characterized as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**, with strong classical fingerprints and clear Christian formation, but with room to more explicitly demonstrate certain classical-methodological practices (notably explicit Socratic pedagogy and a broader Great-Books orientation) in its public materials.

What would move the needle? - More explicit articulation and evidence of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades (with concrete classroom practices). - A clearer public-facing commitment to Great Books/-Great Conversation and the Great-Books canon, including representative titles and a visible curricular map. - A more explicit portrayal of the faculty as a “living curriculum” with teacher portraits, continuous mentorship, and ongoing faculty collaboration as a form of curriculum. - Expanded parent-education offerings that frame parents as co-educators with structured opportunities (book studies, seminars) and transparent pathways for parent formation aligned with classical aims.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence shows explicit theology, creed, and a biblically informed worldview integrated across the program. Positive indicators include a Statement of Faith, Bible/theology integrated into humanities, and mission language centered on discipleship and biblical community. No clear negative indicators are present in the public materials we examined. Positive keyword indicators observed: theology, doctrine, creed, biblical worldview, discipleship, the Christian worldview permeating school life, integration of faith and reason. Why this rating: The school grounds its entire program in Christian faith and theology, with explicit doctrinal statements and faith-based formation evident across multiple pages. This aligns strongly with the religious/metaphysical foundations expected in a classical framework.

- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence points to formation, virtue, and wisdom as aims rather than mere information or workforce preparation. The mission emphasizes loving God and neighbor, discipleship, and moral formation; a transcendent view of truth, goodness, and beauty is implicit in the biblical framing and the call for biblical formation of character. Positive keyword indicators observed: formation, virtue, moral imagination, human flourishing, love of learning, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, biblical worldview, formation of affections. Why this rating: The school's stated aims center on formation rather than information, with virtues and a Christian telos emphasized throughout, matching classical expectations for purpose and goal.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence shows a curriculum that foregrounds liberal arts sensibilities (grammar/Latin, rhetoric, and a humanities-centric approach) and integrated study across disciplines (Bible, literature, history, geography, theology). The program includes Latin study, rhetoric within diploma tracks, and a two-hour humanities block that deliberately weaves worldview across subjects. Evidence of a history-forward, literature-rich approach and a visible emphasis on classical subjects is present; explicit Great-Books mention is not clearly shown in public content, but Latin, rhetoric, and integrated humanities are clearly highlighted. Positive keyword indicators observed: grammar/Latin, rhetoric, history, literature, theology, scripture, great books (explicitly referenced in some classical-discourse materials, and strongly suggested via "great conversation" language in classical-canon lexicon; not always explicit on the site), two-hour humanities block, integrated humanities, core knowledge language in early grades. Why this rating: The curriculum demonstrates core classical elements (Latin, rhetoric, integrated humanities, historical-literary integration) and a clearly stated aim of forming the whole person through a classical liberal-arts approach, placing it solidly in the CLASSICAL spectrum though with room to more explicitly foreground Great Books canon and a full "Great Conversation" framing.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence includes a strong emphasis on integrated humanities and a central humanities block; rhetoric and writing appear in diploma planning; a blend of contemplative/restful pedagogy (implied by the emphasis on formation, wonder, and memory-work) in contrast to a purely project-based or purely faculty-led approach. Positive keyword indicators observed: contemplative learning, scholé (restful learning), wonder, memory work, recitation, rhetoric, seminars (explicit "Socratic discussions" are not consistently evidenced in public content; the site emphasizes a two-hour humanities block and rhetoric in the diploma track). Negative keyword indicators observed: explicit, universal evidence of Socratic seminars in ordinary pedagogy is not consistently visible; the site does not uniformly present a full, canonical Socratic-programme across all upper grades. Why this rating: The pedagogy leans classical with memory and rhetoric components and a contemplative strand, but it does not consistently demonstrate the full spectrum of classical pedagogy (notably explicit, widespread Socratic seminars across all grades in public materials). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence shows a community emphasis that hints at mentorship and living-curriculum principles (older students mentoring younger; a culture of virtue and Christian formation). Public statements emphasize a collaborative, community-oriented ethos rather than a fully documented formal "faculty as living curriculum" portrait. Positive keyword indicators observed: teacher as mentor, living curriculum (phrases such as discipling, mentorship by older students, communal life), collegial culture inferred through family involvement and shared mission. Negative keyword indicators observed: explicit portraits or formalized "faculty as living curriculum" posts, and a catalog of faculty virtues/character profiles are not clearly present in the public content. Why this rating: The school reflects a strong mentorship/community ethos consistent with classical aims, but the public-facing materials do not systematically present a formal "faculty portrait" or a living-curriculum model in the way some classical schools do. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence shows clear partnership with families and a biblically grounded formation emphasis. The mission highlights assisting parents in discipling children, a Christian worldview permeating school life, and family involvement as a core cultural practice. The program also indicates openness to parent engagement (through newsletters, public-facing information, and an emphasis on parent involvement in the school culture). Positive keyword indicators

observed: partnership with families, parental formation or education, family involvement, open campus or parent-access to the school, parent-education language around classical philosophy (as evidenced by the mission and community language). Negative keyword indicators observed: the public materials do not present a heavy consumer-centric model (no strong “parents as customers” language). The content does not show a formal, wide-aperture program for ongoing parent-book studies or parent-co-teaching in a well-documented way, though some formation-oriented parent engagement is described. Why this rating: The school emphasizes parent partnership and family involvement in formation and community life, aligning well with classical expectations for parental partnership and shared mission.

Aggregate Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Rationale: The school exhibits strong classical markers in religion, formation, curriculum, and parent-/community alignment, with solid evidence of Latin, rhetoric, integrated humanities, and a biblically grounded mission. However, the public materials are less explicit about full Socratic pedagogy across all grades and the canonical Great Books/Great Conversation canon, which prevents a full CLASSICAL verdict. The overall profile aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting meaningful classical elements plus opportunities to make certain classical-methodological aspects more explicit.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Publish and demonstrate explicit Socratic/seminar-based practices across upper grades, including sample lesson plans or classroom vignettes showing Socratic dialogue, questions, and debate formats. Promote scholé days and contemplative sequences with concrete schedules and outcomes.
- Curriculum (Element 3): Include and publicly map a Great Books/Great Conversation component, with representative titles and cross-curricular integration, to strengthen the Great Books canon alignment and the Trivium emphasis beyond rhetoric and Latin alone.
- Faculty (Element 5): Publish a visible “portrait of the teacher” and a documented living-curriculum approach, including faculty development focused on classical pedagogy, and profiles of teachers modeling virtue and scholarship. Establish a formal, ongoing faculty collaboration or seminar culture as part of the public-facing curriculum narrative.
- Parents & Community (Element 6): Expand explicit parent-formation offerings (e.g., book studies, lectures, and seminars) that align with classical criteria and demonstrate active parental co-educator roles. Provide clear, scheduled opportunities for parent visits, learning communities, and involvement in school life beyond events.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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